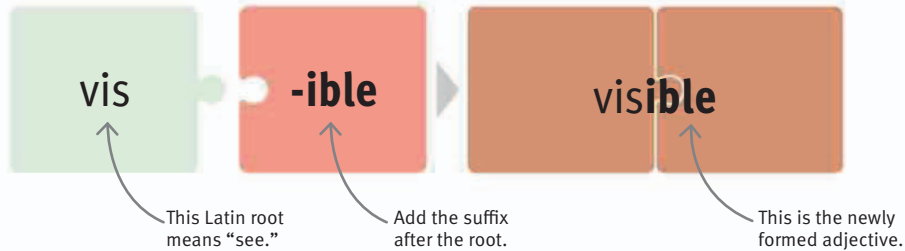


Words ending in -ible

The suffix -ible is usually added to partial root words, many of which have Latin or Greek origins, but it can also be added to complete words. Several rules help to distinguish words that end in -ible from those that end in -able.

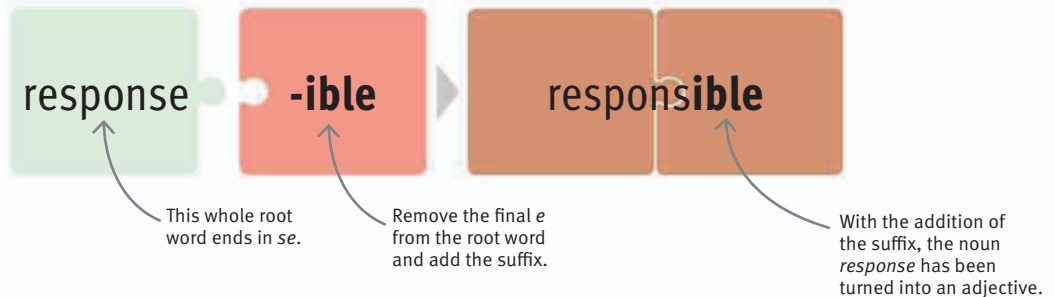
▷ Rule 1

Most words ending in -ible cannot be divided into two English words that make sense on their own. The suffix is needed in order to make a whole word.

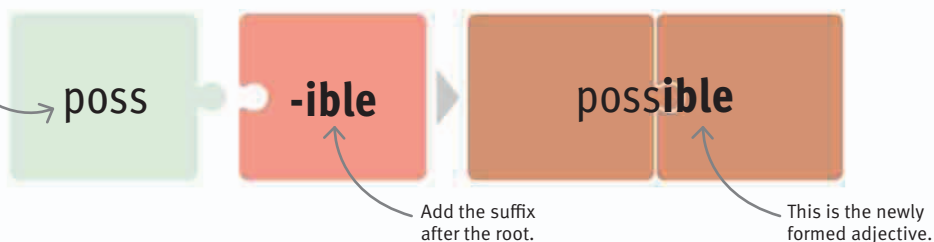


▷ Rule 2

Words with s or ss before the ending usually take -ible. If they end in a vowel, the vowel is dropped.



This partial root word ends in a double s.



Soft and hard “c” and “g” sounds

Words that end in -able usually have a hard “c” or “g” sound. In contrast, words that end in -ible usually have a soft “c” or “g” sound.

Hard “c” or “g” sounds	Soft “c” or “g” sounds
amicable	forcible
communicable	invincible
despicable	reducible
indefatigable	legible
navigable	tangible

The word *uncopyrightable* is the **longest** English **word** in normal use that contains no letter more than **once**.

• Many words that **begin with a** use the **suffix** that also begins with **a**: **-able**. Some common examples include **adorable**, **advisable**, and **available**.